

From the purely functional earphone to the most opulent receivers and amplifiers – audio products are distinct and often at far ends of the quality spectrum.

Products in categories such as high end headphones and custom speakers sometimes reach price points that are unimaginable to most people. The variety in that high-end space is also incredible and your decision at those price points isn't driven purely by measurable factors. Those are mostly playthings of the rich. Regular folks on the other hand are only ever in need of good in-ear headphones and gaming headphones – two of our most popular product categories. Hence, in this recommendation section we'll be concentrating on just those.

Budget In-ear monitors (IEMs)

Whether you're taking your first steps into the audiophile arena or just want the best pair of in-ears for your daily commute, you'll find them all here.

Sennheiser CX180 Street II

The CX 180 has one of the most pleasing sound signatures out there. Not too boomy, and not too shrill, it manages to hit the goldilocks spot of “just right” quite well. It's also for those who can't do without the Sennheiser sound. We particularly like the steel grey variant with its signature ultra small housing.

Price: ₹793



Creative EP-630

At one time the EP-630 had sent Indian forums in a tizzy for the kind of phenomenal price to performance it offered. It was the first time listeners witnessed great audio in the IEM form factor. Sure in today's day and age they don't offer the flat tangle free cables that the likes of the EM1 do, but hey has their aural performance degraded over the years? Of course not! Classics never go out of style. Pick them up